The question in this case, simply put, is whether the corporate identity of the speaker deprives this proposed speech of what otherwise would be its clear entitlement to protection. We turn now to that question.

B

The court below found confirmation of the legislature's definition of the scope of a corporation's First Amendment rights in the language of the Fourteenth Amendment. Noting that the First Amendment is applicable to the States through the Fourteenth, and seizing upon the observation that corporations "cannot claim for themselves the liberty which the Fourteenth Amendment guarantees," *Pierce* v. *Society of Sisters,* 268 U. S. 510, 535 (1925), the court concluded that a corporation's First Amendment rights must derive from its property rights under the Fourteenth.[14]

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be inadequate as applied to individuals might suffice to sustain the same restriction as applied to corporations, unions, or like entities.

[14] The Massachusetts court did not go so far as to accept appellee's argument that corporations, as creatures of the State, have only those rights granted them by the State. See Brief for Appellee 4, 23–25. Cf. MR. JUSTICE WHITE's dissent, *post,* at 809; MR. JUSTICE REHNQUIST's dissent, *post,* p. 822. The court below recognized that such an extreme position could not be reconciled either with the many decisions holding state laws invalid under the Fourteenth Amendment when they infringe protected speech by corporate bodies, *e. g., Linmark Associates, Inc.* v. *Township of Willingboro,* 431 U. S. 85 (1977); *Time, Inc.* v. *Firestone,* 424 U. S. 448 (1976); *Doran* v. *Salem Inn, Inc.,* 422 U. S. 922 (1975); *Southeastern Promotions, Ltd.* v. *Conrad,* 420 U. S. 546 (1975); *Cox Broadcasting Corp.* v. *Cohn,* 420 U. S. 469 (1975); *Miami Herald Publishing Co.* v. *Tornillo,* 418 U. S. 241 (1974); *New York Times Co.* v. *United States,* 403 U. S. 713 (1971); *Time, Inc.* v. *Hill,* 385 U. S. 374 (1967); *New York Times Co.* v. *Sullivan, supra; Kingsley Int'l Pictures Corp.* v. *Regents,* 360 U. S. 684 (1959); *Joseph Burstyn, Inc.* v. *Wilson,* 343 U. S. 495 (1952), or with decisions affording corporations the protection of constitutional guarantees other than the First Amendment. *E. g., United States* v. *Martin Linen Supply Co.,* 430 U. S. 564 (1977) (Fifth Amendment double jeopardy); *G. M. Leasing Corp.* v. *United States,* 429 U. S. 338, 353 (1977) (Fourth Amendment). In any event, appellee's argument is inapplicable to two of the appellants. National banks are creatures of federal law and in-